

MARCELO GANTIER MITA

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics, Political Economy, Environmental Economics.

EDUCATION

Paris School of Economics

Sept. 2022-Present

PhD in Economics

Supervisor: Professor Karen Macours

Research Visit at the University of British Columbia

Sept. 2025-April 2026

Supervisor: Professor Claudio Ferraz

Paris School of Economics

2022

MRes. in Applied Economics: Public Policy and Development (PPD), with *summa cum laude*

Supervisor: Professor Karen Macours

The University of Warwick

2019

MSc. in Economics, with *Distinction*

Supervisor: Professor James Fenske

Bolivian Catholic University (UCB)

2011-2015

Bachelor of Arts *Licenciatura* in Economics, February 2011 – November 2015

PHD DISSERTATION

“Bringing Services Closer to People? Distance to Administrators and the Reach of the State” [[Blog Post](#)] [[Policy Brief](#)] (*Job Market Paper*)

- This paper examines whether bringing local administrators closer to citizens expands the reach of the state in Uganda. Using district proliferation and a policy rule that generated exogenous variation in proximity to new headquarters, the paper finds improvements in service access, citizen engagement, and accountability, but no corresponding increase in trust in government or democratic perceptions.

“Democratization of Justice and Checks and Balances in Bolivia”

- Does the popular election of judges increase judicial independence or facilitate political capture? In 2011, Bolivia became the first country to select its highest court judges by popular vote, aiming to democratize justice and strengthen legitimacy. This paper studies whether this reform affected the courts’ capacity to check the executive. The project combines the universe of high-court rulings since 2001 with judge-level measures of political alignment, exploiting random case assignment within courts to compare decisions in politically sensitive cases assigned to aligned and non-aligned judges.

“Bottom-up Conservation: Sub-national Protected Areas and Local Governance in Bolivia” (with Julia Girard, Jean Paul Benavides, Carlos Quezada)

- Studies whether locally created protected areas improve forest conservation in Bolivia. Using a staggered difference-in-differences design, the paper finds that Municipal Protected Areas do not reduce deforestation on average and can increase forest loss through pasture expansion, especially in municipalities without indigenous territories. The results point to tensions between local conservation initiatives and national land-titling policies.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- “Skills for the Current Generation of Actors in Agricultural Food Systems” (with Karen Macours, Balasai Vanukuri, Amit Khanal)
- “The Effectiveness of Property Rights Interventions in the Pan-Tropics” (with Daniela Miteva, Bronson Griscom, Subhrendu Pattanayak, et al.)

PUBLICATIONS

Papers in Refereed Journals

- “Subjective Expectations and Schooling Choices in Latin America and the Caribbean” (with Andrea Repetto and Rafael Novella) *Journal of International Development*, April 2024.
- “The effect of Government Expenditure on the Economy of Bolivia: an analysis of the 1990-2015 period” (with Germán Molina), *Revista Perspectivas No. 39*, May 2017 (*In Spanish*).
- “The link between Government Expenditure and Economic Growth: The case of Bolivia” (with Germán Molina), *Latin American Journal of Economic Development (LAJED) No. 25*, May 2016 (*In Spanish*).

Book Chapters

- “Rent-seeking in a High Natural Resources Dependency Environment: The case of Bolivia” (with Bernardo Fernández y Martín Palmero) in Research for Bolivian Economic Development, *Academia Boliviana de Ciencias Economicas - Fundación INESAD*, Pag. 169-228, 2019 (*In Spanish*). [[Working paper version](#)] [[Media coverage](#)]
- “The relationship between natural resources and local human development: A blessing or a curse?” in Growth Inequality and the Challenge for sustainability (with Horacio Vera), *Konrad Adenauer Stiftung*, Pag. 141-156, 2018.
- Towards sustainable development in the Andean Region (with Fernanda Wanderley, Horacio Vera, Jean Paul Benavides and Karen Martinez), *Institute of Socio Economic Research (IISEC-UCB)*, 2018 (*In Spanish*).
- “Progress in Economics of Happiness in Bolivia” (with Javier Aliaga, Alejandro Herrera, Luis Serrudo and Miguel Carvajal), *First Edition, SOIPA, Institute of Socio Economic Research (IISEC-UCB)*, November 2017 (*In Spanish*).

Working Papers

- “Measuring Livestock: A Review of Data Gaps and Methodological Opportunities for Livestock Data Collection in Household and Agricultural Survey”, August 2025.
- “The Challenge of Tracking the Reach of Post-Green Revolution Crop Breeding” (with James Stevenson, Greg Traxler, Frederic Kosmowski, and Karen Macours), June 2023.
- “Commodity Shocks, Factor Intensity and Conflicts in Africa”, *IISEC Working Papers series 6/20*, November 2020.
- “Social Debt in Bolivia” (Fernanda Wanderley and Jaime Perez coordinators), *Institute of Socio Economic Research*, July 2017 (*In Spanish*).

RESEARCH GRANTS

CNRS-PSE Development Group “Bottom-up Conservation: Sub-national Protected Areas and Local Governance in Bolivia”. December 2024 (EUR 1,500)

Agence Nationale de la Recherche EUR-PgSE “Turkish Soap Operas and Intimate Partner Violence in Latin America”. October 2024 (EUR 2,500)

CNRS-PSE Development Group “Missing an important part of the picture? Livestock Measurement in Nomadic and Semi-Nomadic System”. July 2024 (EUR 1,000)

International Growth Center (IGC) “Bringing Services Closer to People? Distance to Administrators and Public Service Delivery in Uganda”. April 2024 - February 2025 (GPB 4,135)

Agence Nationale de la Recherche EUR-PgSE “Bringing Services Closer to People? Distance to Administrators and Public Service Delivery in Uganda”. February 2024 (EUR 4,000)

Development Bank of Latin America (CAF)/A.B.C.E./INESAD “Rent-seeking in a High Natural Resources Dependency Environment: The case of Bolivia” (with Bernardo Fernández y Martín Palmero). January 2018 - December 2018 (USD 12,500)

PREVIOUS APPOINTMENTS

Short Term Consultant <i>World Bank (TTL Sydney Gourlay)</i>	<i>Mar 2025 - June 2025</i>
Teaching Assistant in Econometrics II <i>Paris School of Economics (PSE)</i>	<i>Oct 2024 - Dec 2024</i>
Teaching Assistant in Econometrics II <i>Paris School of Economics (PSE)</i>	<i>Oct 2023 - Dec 2023</i>
Research Assistant <i>for Prof. Karen Macours (PSE)</i>	<i>July 2022 - Aug 2022</i>
Pre-doctoral Fellow <i>Research Assistant for Prof. Karen Macours (PSE)/ CGIAR</i>	<i>Sept 2020 - Sept 2021</i>
Consultant <i>Inter-American Development Bank (IADB)</i>	<i>Oct 2019 - May 2020</i>
Instructor in Macroeconomics II <i>Bolivian Catholic University (UCB)</i>	<i>Feb 2020 - June 2020</i>
Junior Researcher <i>Institute of Socio Economic Research (IISEC-UCB)</i>	<i>Aug 2016 - Jun 2018</i>
Instructor in Economics 101 <i>Bolivian Catholic University (UCB)</i>	<i>Aug 2017 - Jun 2018</i>
Assistant Editor LAJED Journal <i>Institute of Socio Economic Research (IISEC-UCB)</i>	<i>Aug 2016 - Jun 2018</i>
Research Assistant <i>Institute of Socio Economic Research (IISEC-UCB)</i>	<i>Feb 2014 - Jul 2016</i>
Consultant <i>Research Project: “Financial System and Economic Growth in Bolivia”</i>	<i>Apr 2015 - Jun 2015</i>
Teaching Assistant <i>Department of Economics Bolivian Catholic University (UCB)</i>	<i>Feb 2012 - Nov 2015</i>

EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS

2026:	STEG Annual Conference (Nairobi), PacDev 2026 (UC, Davis), Dev/PE internal seminar VSE-UBC, AFÉPOP 2026 (Strasbourg University), Nordic Conference on Development Economics (Linnaeus University), International Conference in Development Economics (AFEDEV - Rouen University), 2nd Junior Workshop on Economics of Latin America (Berlin School of Economics), Oxford Development Economics Workshop (OXDEV) 2026*, 2027 ASSA Annual Meeting (AEA poster session)*
2025:	Applied Research Workshop (Bolivian Catholic University)
2024:	EPD Jamboree (Pompeu Fabra University), 2nd Essex PhD Conference in Applied Economics 12th Warwick Economics PhD Conference, Monthly Seminar Series Makerere University, Bolivian Conference on Development Economics (15th BCDE)
2023:	International Conference in Development Economics (AFEDEV - Paris School of Economics), Bolivian Conference on Development Economics (14th BCDE)

*Scheduled

AWARDS AND DISTINCTIONS

Master PPD (Paris School of Economics) Awarded Best Teaching Assistant of 2023/2024	<i>2025</i>
Doctoral Contract ED 465 (Paris 1 Pantheon-Sorbonne) Recipient of a Full Scholarship to study at The Paris School of Economics	<i>2022</i>
Master PPD Scholarship (Paris School of Economics) Recipient of a Partial Scholarship to study at The Paris School of Economics	<i>2021</i>
Chevening Scholarship (Foreign and Commonwealth Office - UK) Recipient of a Full Scholarship to study at The University of Warwick	<i>2018</i>
National Award for the Best Undergraduate Dissertation in Economics Central Bank of Bolivia, 9th Bolivian Economists' Forum	<i>2016</i>
IISEC-UCB Scholarship for the Summer School “Multidimensional Poverty” Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative (OPHI), University of Oxford	<i>2017</i>

OTHER INFORMATION

Affiliations: Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association (LACEA), Association Française d'Economie du Développement (AFEDEV), Association Française des Économistes de la Population (AFÉPOP), Elected member of the directors' board at the Bolivian Society of Economists (SEBOL) 2024-2026

Programming: STATA, L^AT_EX, Arc/Q-GIS, R, Python.

Online Courses: Data Analysis for Social Scientists ([MITx-June 2021](#)), Political Economy and Economic Development ([MITx-Sep. 2020](#)), Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations ([MITx-June 2020](#)), The Challenges of Global Poverty ([MITx-May 2017](#)).

Languages: Spanish (native), English (advanced), French (intermediate-B1).

REFERENCES

Karen Macours PhD, *Professor, Department of Economics, Paris School of Economics* | karen.macours@psemail.eu

James Fenske PhD, *Professor, Department of Economics, University of Warwick* | J.Fenske@warwick.ac.uk

Manuel Bagues PhD, *Professor, Department of Economics, University of Warwick* | Manuel.Bagues@warwick.ac.uk

Rafael Novella PhD, *Senior Research Fellow at University of College London* | r.novella@ucl.ac.uk

Fernanda Wanderley PhD, *Director, IISEC-UCB* | fwanderley@ucb.edu.bo

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